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City of London School for Girls: 11+ English Sample (2016)

School: City of London School for Girls
Subject: English
Level: 11+
Time: 40 mins
Type: Sample Paper
Year in use: 2016

Part A

Q	Sample Answers	Action
1.	He was appreciating the warmth in anticipation of the cold evening.	
2.	• The picture that is hanging askew on the wall. • The memory of a strange man who had been in his house 4 months ago who he had lost sight of.	
3.	The writer is describing John's feeling of excitement that comes with unfolding a big and important discovery.	

search

Q	Sample Answers	Action
4.	First, John used a pen knife to carefully loose some paints. Then he cut off some wood at the joint big enough for inserting a poker. Lastly, he forced the door open with a sharp force.	
5.	(a) The pen knife that John was trying to use to open the cupboard wasn't made to cut through layers of thick paint.(b) John was barely able to contain his excitement. / John was very excited.	
6.	He thinks that the cupboard is empty and has not been used for a long time.	
7.	John was physically excited at the idea of finding the violin but he was also confused because he was unsure as to how the violin came to be in the cupboard in the first place. He also felt a little childish for being so excited about finding a violin in an old cupboard.	
8.	We know that the violin has survived in good condition because the writer tells that that underneath the layers of dust John could see a beautiful violin with `delicate curves of the body and of the scroll` and that it did not seem to have been damaged with the passage of time. The body of the violin is varnished to a nearly new condition. If the violin had not been in good shape the author would have described the violin with scratches and cracks and not as an instrument of beauty	
9.	It has a longer neck and remarkably bold and free scroll.	
10.	The violin made a positive impression on John because when he compared it to his current instrument he could see the `superiority of the violin in every detail` and this gave me a conviction regarding the exceptional value of the instrument. The writer also says that the `extreme beauty of the instrument impressed him vividly` and his overall impression is that he is standing in the presence of a masterpiece.	
11.	Because Stradivarius violins are rare and highly coveted, the label saying that it was a Stradivarius violin would most likely be a forgery.	

Q	Sample Answers	Action
12.	The writer uses language to make the discovery of the violin exciting by highlighting the emotions that John is feeling as the passage progresses. He uses phrases indicating strong emotions such as “a feverish anxiety” (Line 18) and “reached an overmastering pitch” (Line 23-24). The writer gives details of John’s emotional up and down (written in longer paragraphs) to make the discovery of the violin exciting. We see John excited with anticipation as he realizes that there is something behind the picture frame. “His curiosity was excited …” (line 14). This excitement mounts as he works to open the mysterious hidden cupboard. “… his heart beat so fast that he could scarcely catch his breath …” (line 32). Once the cupboard is open we see this excitement dissipate almost immediately when John concludes that the cupboard has nothing more than dust and cobwebs in it. “His sense of disappointment was keen as he thrust his hand into it …” (Line 35-36). This disappointment is fleeting when he puts his hand into the cupboard and feels something solid. “John was excited at his discovery, and felt his thoughts confused.” (Line 44). His breathless excitement returns as he works to find a light and to remove the object in order to discover what it is. “The extreme beauty of its varnish impressed him vividly …” (Line 68) / “he felt a conviction gradually gaining …” (Line 69). In addition to the words that describe John`s excitement the writer also provides many words that leave the reader wondering about what John found. We are left wondering as we walk step by step through the discovery alongside John. For example, when John removes the violin from the cupboard the writer describes it as being covered with “the curious drapery of black and clinging cobwebs” (Line 40). John then moves the instrument with great care “as he feared lest age should have rendered the wood brittle or rotten” (Line 47-48). Before John opens the case, he clears the thick cobwebs “with some vigorous puffs of breath and a little dusting with a handkerchief “ (Line 48-49). Finally, he takes the violin out after “A few minutes more gentle handling” (Line 51).	

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